

COLLAPSE FOLLOWING VACCINATION

Collapse

- Call for help.
- Lie patient on his/her back and raise legs.
- Check response: if unresponsive, check circulation, airway and breathing.
 - If no pulse/not breathing, start CPR → 14.
 - If breathing and pulse present: assess timing of collapse and duration of loss of consciousness and check breathing, pulse and BP:

- Collapse occurred suddenly, at the time of injection (before, during or immediately after).
- Loss of consciousness usually lasts 20 seconds to 1 minute and is relieved by lying patient down and raising legs.
- BP: briefly low but rapidly normal again.
- Pulse may be slow.
- Breathing usually normal but may be rapid, deep (hyperventilation).
- No other signs or symptoms present.

- Collapse occurred 5-10 minutes after the injection (could occur up to 1 hour after).
- Loss of consciousness is not brief and not relieved by lying patient down and raising legs.
- BP < 90/60 and remains low
- Pulse > 120
- Breathing: may have wheeze, stridor, cough
- Other signs and symptoms (like swelling or rash) present.

Fainting episode likely

Management:

- If not already done, lie patient flat and raise legs.
- Loosen any tight clothing: undo buttons around the neck, loosen tie/or tight belt.
- Apply cool cloth to face/neck.
- Calmly reassure patient – explain what happened and assure them that they will be alright.
- Check for any other injuries they may have sustained falling.
- Stay with the patient until they are fully recovered. Patient should remain lying with legs up until feeling better.

Refer if:

- Head injury.
- Known with a heart condition or other serious illness.
- Patient has unusual symptoms, such as chest pain, shortness of breath, confusion, blurred vision, or difficulty talking.

Report:

- Report electronically using the Med Safety app or complete NDoH Case Reporting Form (CRF) for Adverse Events Following Immunisation (AEFI) and report to sub-district or district office and provincial EPI manager within 24 hours.
- Replace all medications/equipment used and seal emergency kit.

Treat as anaphylaxis → 20.